‘How to survive Artificial Intelligence’ guide 🤖

First of all, welcome to the ‘Vrije Universiteit van Amsterdam!’ A whole new period of your life is about to start and believe me it will be an exciting one. You probably have many questions about how everything works. Don't worry, we have compiled everything for you. At the beginning of the guide, there are the QR-codes to the WhatsApp groups, where you can always ask any questions you may have!

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WhatsApp group

For AI year 1 25/26, a study chat has been created where you can ask questions to your fellow and older students. Furthermore, useful materials will be exchanged here.

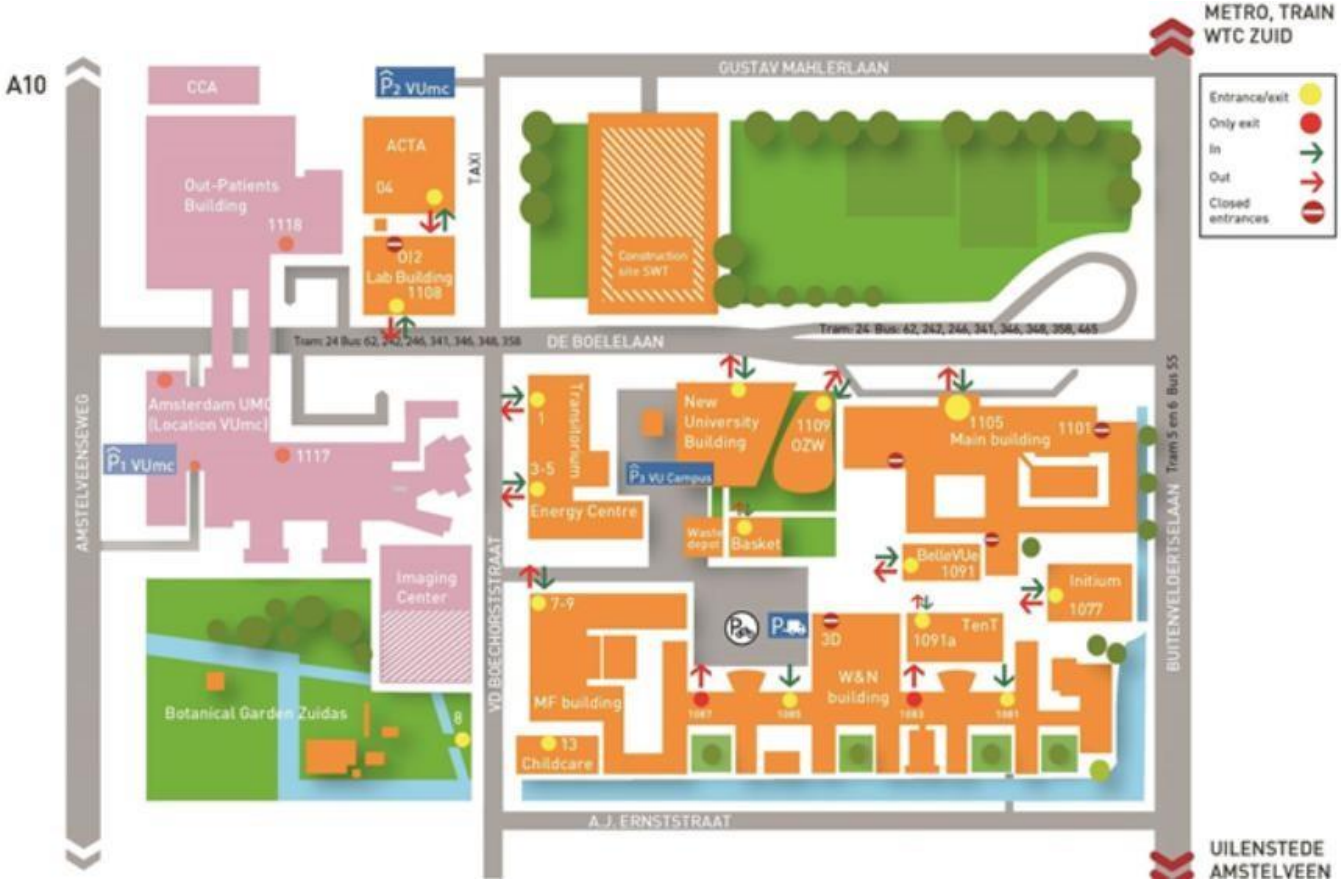
You can join the chat by scanning the following QR:

SCAN ME

Or join using this link:
https://chat.whatsapp.com/Fax2ctVh49w3fyAgl9wAAJ

The VU Campus

The VU Campus is located at the Boelelaan in Amsterdam Zuid. Below you'll find a map of the campus. On campus, you will find multiple buildings with lecture halls, as well as plenty of dining options and quiet study areas. Most of the exams will be held at the campus, however some exams are at Uilenstede or in the RAI Conference Centre.



Buildings

There are different buildings at the VU Campus. Here is a list of all the buildings and their abbreviations:

Main building (also known as Hoofdgebouw) →	HG
New Building (also known as Nieuwe Universiteitsgebouw) →	NU
Initium →	IN
Tent Tentamenzaal →	TenT
MF-building →	MF
W&N building →	W&N
OZW/InHolland →	OZW

How to find your classroom

The timetable states where your lectures are located. An example is **HG-09A29.** This means you have to be in the Main Building (Hoofdgebouw), on the **9th floor** in the **A-wing**, in **classroom 29.** Most of the lectures are located in the Main Building or the Initium Building. Most of the workgroups will be in the Main Building and the New Building.

Curriculum

Structure

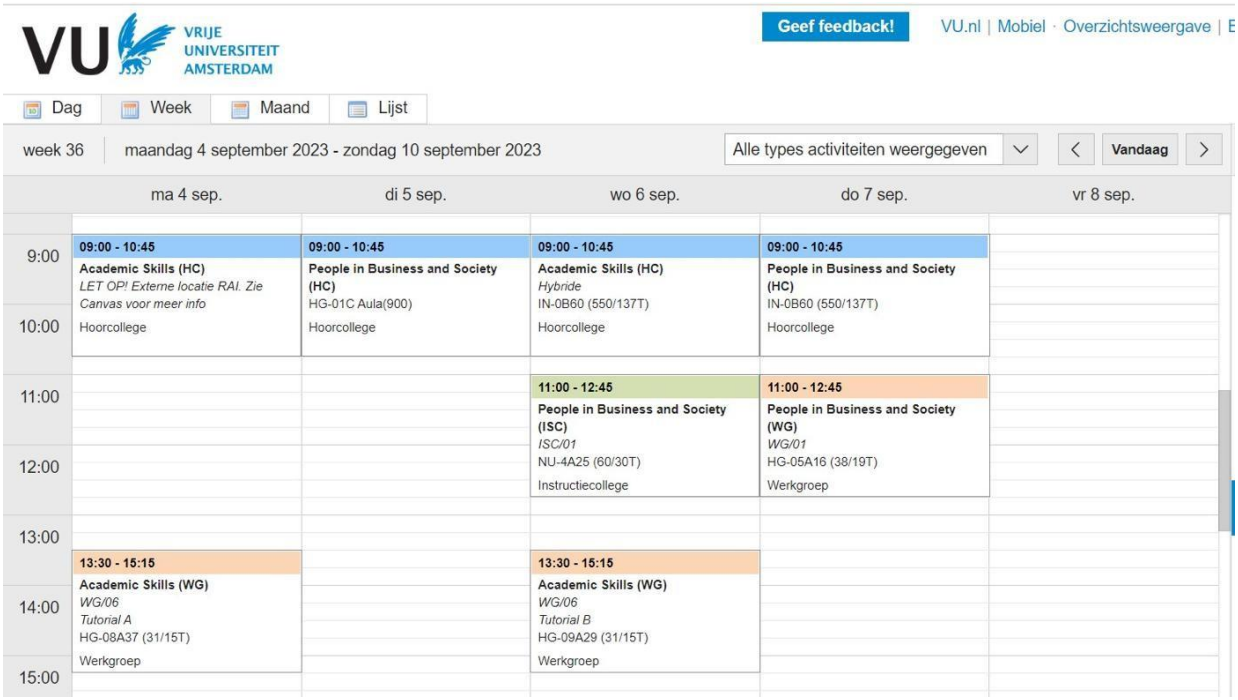
The Bachelor's Artificial Intelligence is divided into 6 periods. The 1st, 2nd, 4th and 5th period are 8 weeks long and consist of: 6 weeks of lectures, workgroups and instruction lectures, followed by one week for resits and study time (week 7) and an exam week (week 8).
Sometimes you'll have midterms or deadlines during the first 6 weeks of the period, or you'll have the exam week in week 7 and the resits in week 8. The 3rd and 6th period are 4 weeks long.

In December you will have vacation from the 23rd of December till the 5th of January. Below you can find the link to VU calendar for the whole year.

Link: https://vu.nl/en/education/more-about/academic-calendar

Schedule

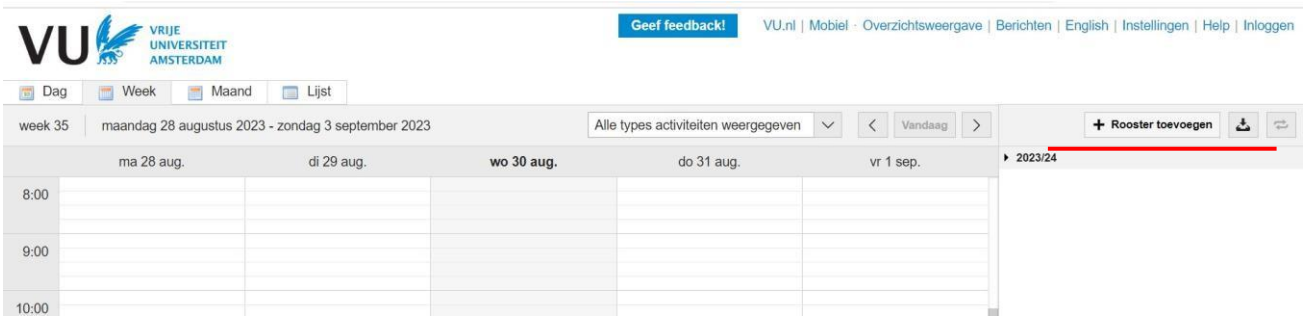
Every period consists of lectures, workgroups, and instructional lectures. A week can look like this (PS this is just an example of coursework):



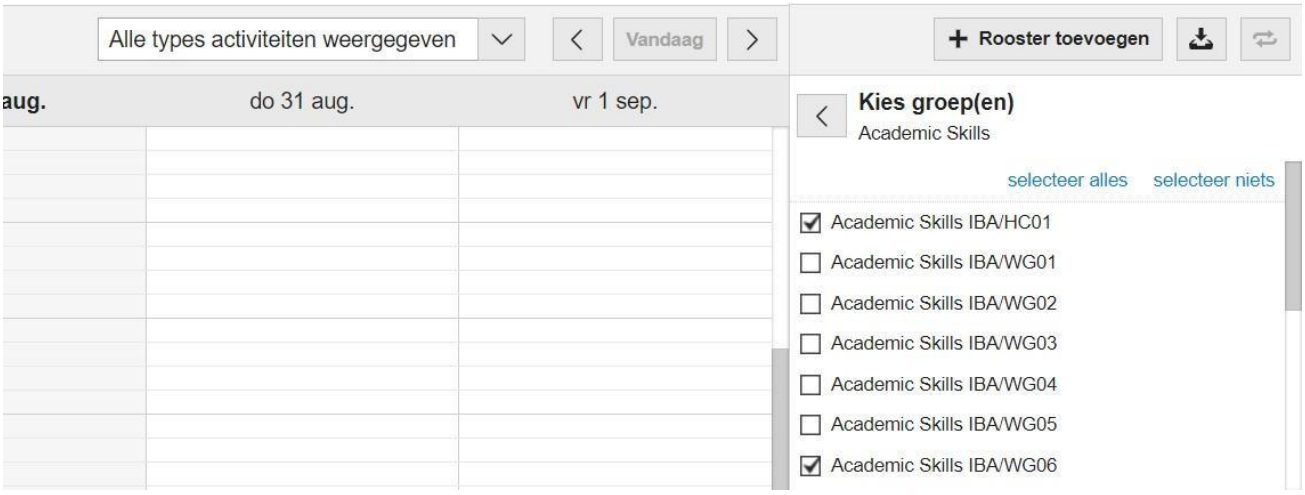
How to select the right schedule:

1. Go to: https://rooster.vu.nl.

2. Click on 'Rooster toevoegen' or 'Add Schedule'



3. Click on 'Group' or 'Groep'. You can now select a Faculty: 'of Science'(you are looking for faculty of science for now) and a study program: '1st year bachelor Artificial Intelligence'.
4. Select for every course which workgroup and which instruction lecture you are in. Your screen will look like the picture below:


Alle types activiteiten weergegeven
Vandaag
Rooster toevoegen
aug.
do 31 aug.
vr 1 sep.
Kies groep(en)
Academic Skills
selecteer alles
selecteer niets
Academic Skills IBA/HC01
Academic Skills IBA/WG01
Academic Skills IBA/WG02
Academic Skills IBA/WG03
Academic Skills IBA/WG04
Academic Skills IBA/WG05
Academic Skills IBA/WG06

Canvas

Canvas is the online learning environment used by the VU. At Canvas you can find the material you'll need for your courses, such as lecture slides or assignments with their explanations. On the Canvas page teachers will furthermore upload announcements about the assignments, lectures, or exams.

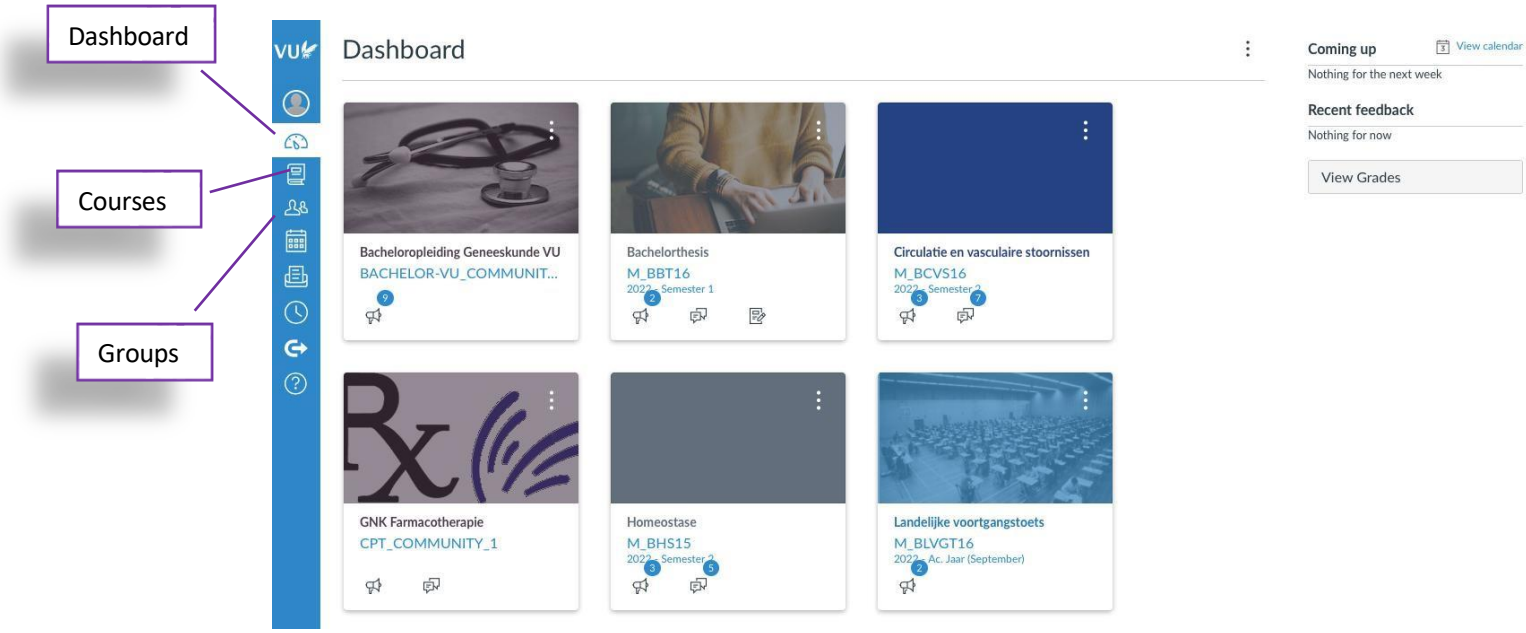
How to log in:

1. Click on this link to go to the Canvas page: https://discovery.canvas.login.vu.nl/
2. At the Canvas page, click the button: "Met een VUnetID"

3. You've received your VUnetID in the mail and can change the password to your own password.
4. If you're logged in, you'll arrive at the Dashboard of Canvas!

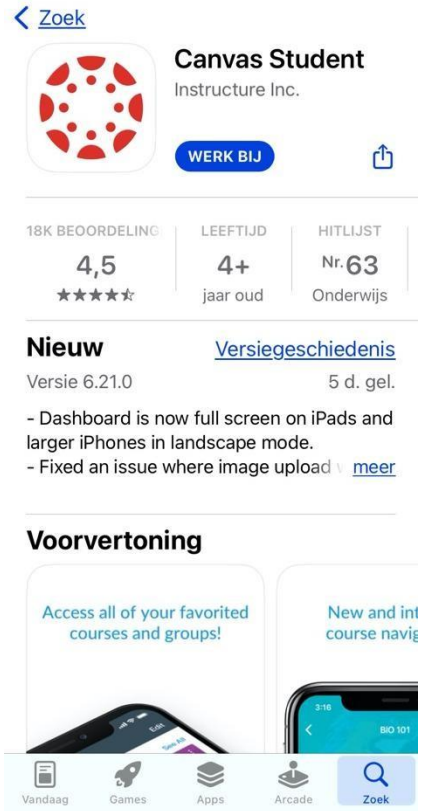
Dashboard

The canvas dashboard can look as follows:



Canvas-app

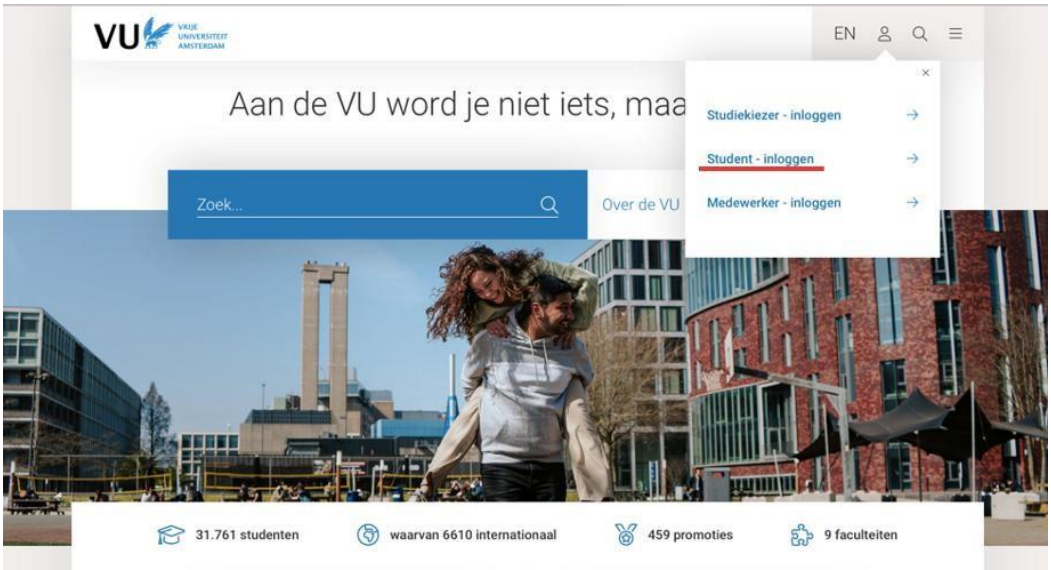
There is also a Canvas-app for your phone. You can download the app in the App Store or Google Play Store-app.



VUnet

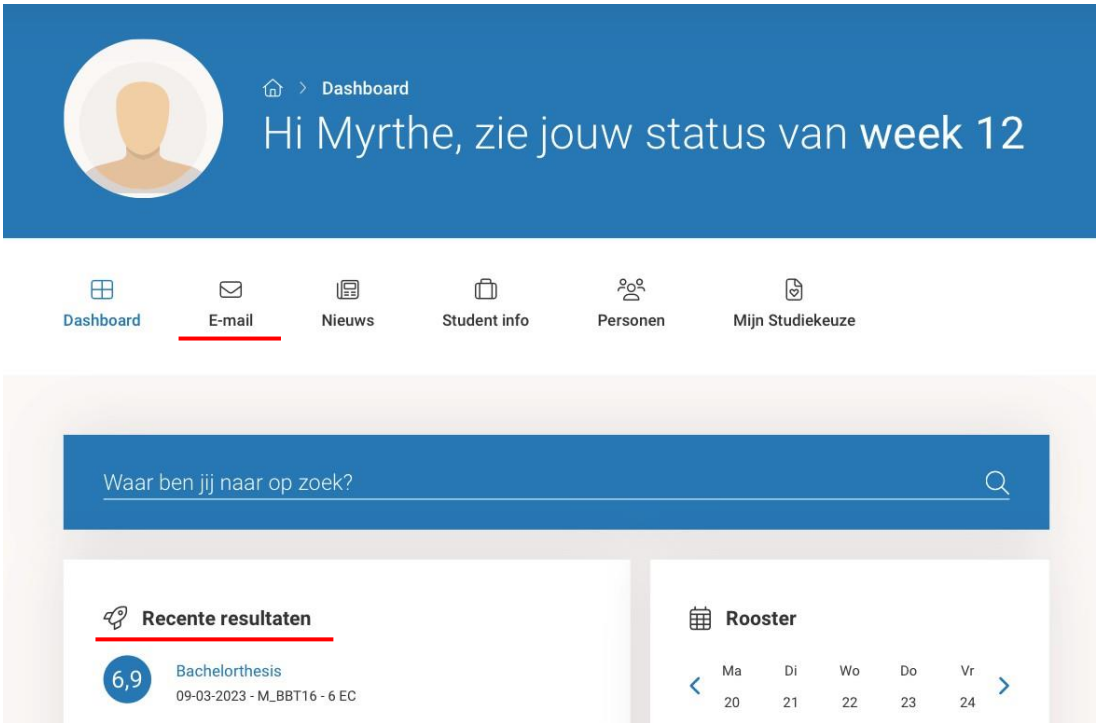
Log In

To log in at the VUnet website, you go to: https://vu.nl.
You click on 'Student – inloggen'. After that it works the same as with Canvas and you can log in with your VUnetID.



Dashboard

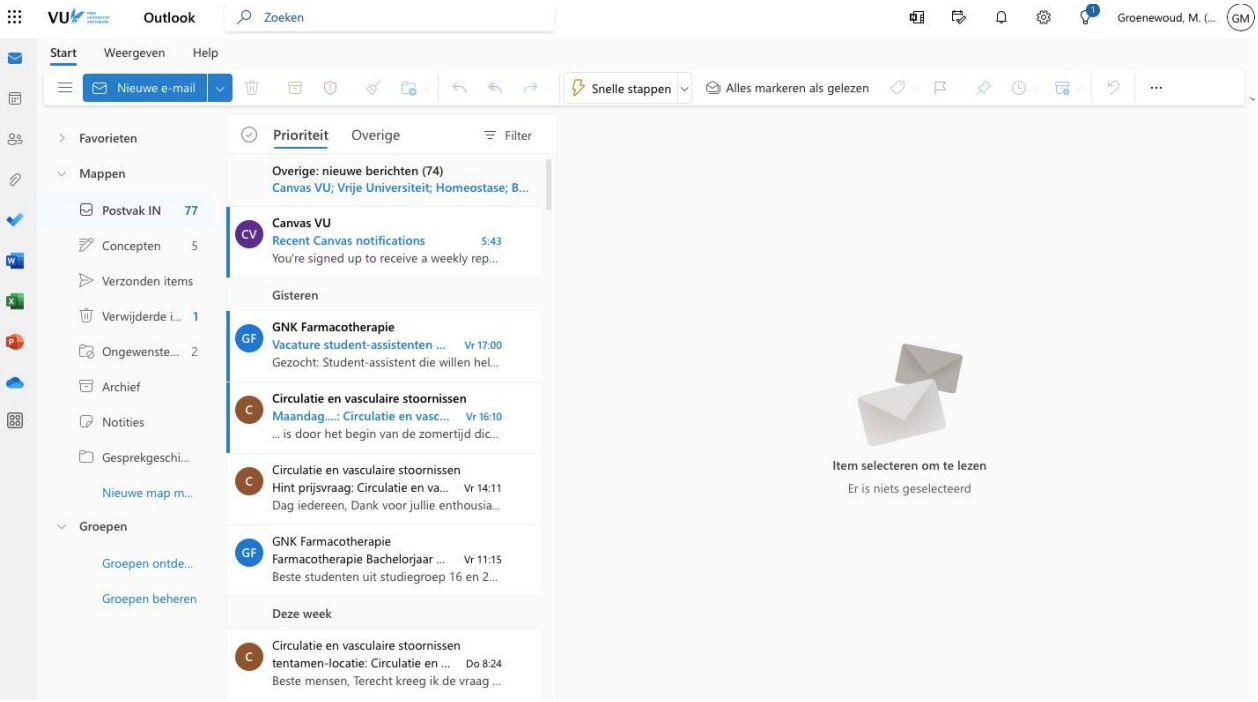
After you've logged in, you'll arrive at the Dashboard of VUnet. Here you can find your grades and results. Furthermore, you can go to your VU mail.



VU mail

It is important to check your student mail regularly. Your student mail consists of:
initial.lastname@student.vu.nl or studentnumber@student.vu.nl
So for example if your name is Piet Jansen and your student number is 123456 it will be:
p.jansen@student.vu.nl or 123456@student.vu.nl.

Your VUmail will look like this:



If you want to mail a teacher or someone else at the faculty, it's important to use your VUmail and not your personal mail. This way they'll see your mail way faster!

Results

At the Dashboard in VUnet, you can find the results of your courses. If you click on the arrow, you can see your grades.

Medisch wetenschappelijk onderzoek 1	M_BMWO115	Semester 1	18-12-2020	6	8,5	
Metabole systemen	M_BMS15	Semester 1	20-11-2020	6	9,0	
Bouw en bewegen	M_BBB15	Semester 1	23-10-2020	6	7,5	
Huid en afweer	M_BHA15	Semester 1	25-09-2020	6	8,0	
Arts en pati►►nt 2	M_BAP215	Semester 2	31-05-2021	6	8,0	
CAT Arts en pati►►nt 2: Autonomie		Semester 2	31-05-2021		8,1	
Hersenen en zintuigen	M_BHZ15	Semester 2	23-04-2021	6	7,5	
Circulatie en volumeregulatie	M_BCV15	Semester 2	26-03-2021	6	8,5	
Homeostase	M_BHS15	Semester 2	26-02-2021	6	8,5	

Important: your grade has to be a 5.5 to pass a course! So not a 5.4 or a 5.45, but at least a 5.5. To complete your bachelor's degree, you will need to pass all your courses. Good to know; you will need to pass all the first-year courses, to start a minor or go on exchange in year 3. If you don't pass a course, don't worry! You can resit the course in the same year. If you don't manage to pass, you can retake the course next year.

Tips

- Attend **lectures** as much as possible and actively participate. In the lectures, you will get an introduction to the material, which will be applied in tutorials.
- Stay focused during the lectures by **taking notes**. Don't try to write down everything the teacher says, but jot down the key points for yourself so you can review them later. Alternatively, you can actively listen during the lecture and then review the slides and take notes at home.
- Don't hesitate to **ask questions**. Professors are there to teach you and answer your questions, so feel free to ask. Your fellow students might also be able to help with various questions.
- **Exam trainings** are very useful to review all the material and do practice exercises before the exam. It complements what you have learned in lectures and from books, as you get the chance to practice the material thoroughly. It's also helpful that you can ask direct questions to the instructor giving the training!
- **Summaries** are also handy to review the material or prepare for a lecture. IBA uses many different books, and summaries can provide a more organized overview.
    - You can create your own summary, but it can be time-consuming. So start early if you choose to do so.
- **Start studying for the exam early**. Don't underestimate the amount of material! If you don't start early, you might find out later that you have much more to study than you initially thought.
- Practice, practice, and practice! Take as many **practice exams** as possible. Professors often reuse old exam questions.
- Take frequent **short breaks** instead of one long break. On average, people can concentrate for about 45 minutes at a time. Anything you study after that will be absorbed less effectively. Don't expect yourself to study for hours on end. You can use techniques like the Pomodoro technique with time blocks: 25 minutes of studying, 5 minutes break, and after 3 or 4 blocks of 25 minutes, a 15-30 minute break. During your break, do something different, like taking a walk or getting a drink/snack.
- Set clear, small **goals**. Reward yourself when you achieve a goal.
- Find a **study space** where you can work effectively. It's very tempting to study on your bed, but you may get easily distracted. The perfect spot varies for everyone but try to find a place where you can truly concentrate. Experiment with different spots and see what works best for you.
- Besides studying, it's also crucial to engage in **social activities**. Join a study or student association, for example. Try to have enough free time alongside your studies to make the most of your student life!

3 out of 4-method

If you use the so called '3 out of 4-method', you'll have a big chance of passing your exams. The 4 study methods are: reading the literature, going to, and studying the lectures, following exam trainings, and reading summaries (selfmade or from Athena). Choose the 3 (out of 4) methods that fit you best and you're on track to pass your exams with a really good grade!

3 out of 4-method

Contact Athena

- **AthenaStudies:** info@athenastudies.nl
- **AthenaSummary:** Info@athenasummary.nl
- **For other general questions:** info@athenastudies.nl